

findings

OpenDesign Integration Audit (§11.4.162) — Findings

Field	Value
Date	2026-06-22
Scope	helix_code consumer + constitution submodule
Method	Read-only audit, captured evidence (§11.4.6/§11.4.123)
Verdict	WIRED-BUT-DORMANT + NOT CONSUMED BY ANY UI

Overall status

The OpenDesign MCP entry exists but is disabled: true, the daemon is down, no enforcement gate is implemented, and every HelixCode UI theme is hand-coded hardcoded hex — **zero OpenDesign tokens anywhere**.

Captured evidence (verified 2026-06-22)

- open-design-mcp v0.16.1 installed (homebrew, /opt/homebrew/bin/open-design-mcp).
- .mcp.json open-design entry = "disabled": true; env OD_DAEMON_URL=http://localhost:7456.
- curl localhost:7456 → **HTTP 000 (curl exit 7)** — daemon NOT running.
- open-design-mcp binary without env → FATAL: invalid core env vars - OD_DAEMON_URL: Required. Functionally inert.
- internal/theme/builtin.go has light+dark, but as **Go-pinned palettes**, not OD-sourced.
- applications/desktop/theme.go uses hardcoded brand hex constants (hxcPrimary = "#A8DD22" ..., “always dark”, no light variant) — the ad-hoc pattern §11.4.162 forbids.
- No tokens.json / .css / design-tokens artifact exists anywhere.
- §11.4.162 anchor present in all 5 constitution carriers + repo CLAUDE.md, but **MISSING** from assets/{CLAUDE,AGENTS}.md and submodules/helix_agent/{CLAUDE,AGENTS}.md.
- find constitution scripts -iname '*opendesign*' → **empty**. Neither CM-OPENDESIGN-UI-SYSTEM nor CM-COVENANT-114-162-

PROPAGATION is implemented as a script; both exist only as governance prose.

- No visual-regression test harness wired to any HelixCode UI surface.
- Doc drift: docs/OPENSIGN.md (filename typo) references nonexistent assets/Logo.jpeg (actual: assets/Logo.png).

Per-requirement compliance table

Req	Requirement	Status	Evidence
(a)	OpenDesign mandatory for every surface, not ad-hoc CSS	MISSING	Only .mcp.json refs OD; themes are hardcoded hex; MCP disabled+dormant
(b)	Installed dep; tokens for color(light+dark), typography, spacing, component	PARTIAL	Binary installed but disabled; brand colors are Go constants, no token file, no typography/spacing tokens
(c)	Every component ships light+dark	PARTIAL	inner theme has both; desktop Fyne brand = always-dark, no light
(d)	No overlap/font collision/label overlay	MISSING (unverified)	No layout-regression check exists
(e)	All UI changes covered incl. visual-regression	MISSING	No visual-regression harness for HelixCode UI
(f)	Both gates + paired §1.1 mutation	PARTIAL	Anchor text in 6 files; NO gate scripts; no mutation

Totals: 0 COMPLIANT / 3 PARTIAL / 3 MISSING.

Remediation plan

Constitution level (do FIRST — mandate is currently unenforceable)

- Author CM-OPENDESIGN-UI-SYSTEM gate script (does not exist) asserting: OD is a declared dependency, a token artifact exists and is consumed (no ad-hoc hex in theme files), light+dark variants present, visual-regression tests cover UI.
- Author CM-COVENANT-114-162-PROPAGATION gate (scan fleet for literal 11.4.162)
 - paired §1.1 mutation (strip literal → FAIL; inline-hex-for-token → FAIL; light-only component → FAIL). Keep project-agnostic per §11.4.28; consumer registers token path + UI globs per §11.4.35.

helix_code consumer level

- Stand up the OD daemon (Docker per OPENDESIGN.md), set `.mcp.json` `disabled:false`, confirm `curl localhost:7456` healthy.
- Generate a design-token source from `assets/Logo.png` (light+dark palettes, typography, spacing) via `OpenDesign` → tracked token file.
- Refactor `applications/desktop/theme.go` + `internal/theme` to consume the token file instead of hardcoded hex; add a light brand variant for desktop.
- Add per-pixel/perceptual visual-regression tests for desktop/TUI/web, wired into the standard suite.
- Propagate §11.4.162 into `assets/` + `submodules/helix_agent/governance` files.
- Fix doc drift: rename `docs/OPENSIGN.md` → `OPENDESIGN.md`; correct `assets/Logo.jpeg` → `assets/Logo.png`.

Conclusion

CM-OPENDESIGN-UI-SYSTEM gate MUST be authored; it currently has zero implementation. `OpenDesign` is documented and MCP-wired but functionally dormant and consumed by no UI — the §11.4.162 mandate is presently unenforced and unmet.